

Daily Bible Note

Date: September 3, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Psalm 119:33–48

33 Teach me, O Lord, the way of Your statutes, and I shall keep it to the end.

34 Give me understanding, and I shall keep Your law; indeed, I shall observe it with my whole heart.

35 Make me walk in the path of Your commandments, for I delight in it.

36 Incline my heart to Your testimonies, and not to covetousness.

37 Turn away my eyes from looking at worthless things, and revive me in Your way.

38 Establish Your word to Your servant, who is devoted to fearing You.

39 Turn away my reproach which I dread, for Your judgments are good.

40 Behold, I long for Your precepts; revive me in Your righteousness.

41 Let Your mercies come also to me, O Lord—Your salvation according to Your word.

42 So shall I have an answer for him who reproaches me, for I trust in Your word.

43 And take not the word of truth utterly out of my mouth, for I have hoped in Your ordinances.

44 So shall I keep Your law continually, forever and ever.

45 And I will walk at liberty, for I seek Your precepts.

46 I will speak of Your testimonies also before kings, and will not be ashamed.

47 And I will delight myself in Your commandments, which I love.

48 My hands also I will lift up to Your commandments, which I love, and I will meditate on Your statutes.

II. Key Summary

- Every verse from 33 to 40 carries a request to God: teach me Your statutes, give me understanding, make me walk in Your commandments, incline my heart to Your testimonies and not to covetousness, turn my eyes from worthless things, establish Your word to me, turn away the reproach I dread, revive me in Your righteousness.
 - Being shamed comes up three times here: he asks God to turn away the reproach he dreads (39), he says that when God's mercy and salvation come he will have an answer for the one who reproaches him (42), and he says he will speak of God's testimonies before kings and not be ashamed (46).
 - From verse 41 on the tone changes, from "please do this" to "I will": I will keep Your law continually, I will walk at liberty, I will speak of Your testimonies before kings, I will delight myself in Your commandments, I will lift up my hands to them, I will meditate on Your statutes.
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III. Passage Analysis

What pulls your eyes away is something to bring to God

Our natural life is easily drawn to "worthless things" that have no eternal value, so we should ask God to "turn away my eyes from looking at worthless things," to keep us from temptation, so that we can live wholeheartedly in His way. Only trained eyes can keep from being lured by what is worthless. [1]

What the psalmist asks for is "turn away my eyes from looking at worthless things, and revive me in Your way" — the two halves go together, because eyes leave one thing when they land on another. And he does not grit his teeth and do it himself; he asks God for it.

Liberty is not being unsupervised; it is not being tied up

"I will walk at liberty, freed from that which is evil, not hampered with the fetters of my own corruptions, and free to that which is good, doing it not by constraint, but willingly." The service of sin is perfect slavery; the service of God is perfect liberty. [2]

Right after "I will walk at liberty" the psalmist says "for I seek Your precepts" — his freedom comes from digging into God's word day after day. The margin of the text notes that "at

liberty" is literally "in a large place."

IV. Reflection Question

Where have your eyes and your time been landing most these past few days?

The psalmist did not look away by his own willpower; he asked God to "turn away my eyes from looking at worthless things" and to "incline my heart to Your testimonies" — because it is God who works in us both to will and to do (Philippians 2:13).

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Site (ccbiblestudy.org), Comprehensive Bible Interpretation (聖經綜合解讀), Psalm 119,
<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/19Psa/19GT119.htm>

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Complete Commentary, Psalm 119,
https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/Psa/Psa_119.cfm